Dr Sanjeev Kumar Shrivastava (standing second from left) and team

scientific community. We have more than 23 IITs and ICMR labs, 399 state universities, and so on. One can also register as a supplier for their product and if the researchers in these labs need it, the portal (*https://www.istem.gov.in/supplier/home*) can act as a one-stop solution for both users and suppliers.

Q. Being a government-sponsored portal, I-STEM's reach is obviously nationwide. But is there any way a user can find information specifically pertaining to the region he is operating in?

A. We have created an R&D map (*https://www.istem.gov.in/research*) that gives the idea of the kind of research going on in universities so that if anybody is looking for details of that particular area of research in his region, they will be able to contact the researcher as well as the supervisor and get the information.

There is also a programme of the Office of the PSA that has established City Knowledge and Innovation clusters that are called Science and Technology Clusters, currently in six cities including Jodhpur, Pune, Hyderabad, Bhubaneswar, and one coming up in Bengaluru, which will be part of the Indian Institute of Science (IISc) in Bengaluru. The whole purpose of these clusters is to connect all the researchers on a regional level. I-STEM, listed with government agencies, industries, and academies, will provide a platform as needed to all the custodians and users of the City Knowledge and Innovation Clusters.

Q. Many electronics startups fail while IT and software startups seem to have high chances of success. Any thoughts on why?

A. When talking about electronics startups, we have never really taken the time to analyse what exactly does our Indian market as well as society require. We need to analyse what product/service/solution is needed in the industry, what is the ecosystem in the country, and whether it suits our startups or not. If we recognise this, we can make it succeed. The number one proof of that is the fact that many Chinese companies are selling those products in our country. If these things are not taken care of, it will definitely be a failure, because the world is moving very fast in this space.

Q. In the electronics space, which verticals do you believe will see the highest growth in India?

A. I see that the current requirement is electric vehicles and healthcare, especially under present circumstances, which have shown us the importance of robust healthcare infrastructure. I think we should focus on and promote these sectors.

Q. Any advice for entrepreneurs of startups to stand out and stay in the game longer?

A. I would like to advise startups in the country to become the technology leaders worldwide instead of being a supplier to any other country/multinational companies. What I have seen generally happen is that once entrepreneurs build the startup, they transfer that technology to some big company, and the initial idea that drove them to create their own company goes to dust with this transfer to ownership. Instead of selling off their company, founders should strive to evolve their startup into a big company that becomes known for creating world-class products. That, in turn, will help the growth of our country as a manufacturer of high-quality products as well, which goes well in line with our government's *'Atmanirbhar Bharat'* vision. END

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